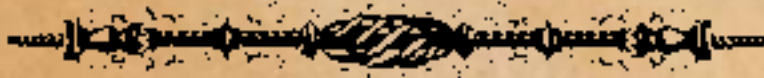


Please Join Us For

A Knight of Murder



Hear ye! Hear ye!
All ye Kings and Queens,
Knights and Nobles!

A tournament celebration is planned to honor the noble marriage of Baron Bartholomew to Lady Diana of Dunnsberry in the manor of Fernwood. As a resident of the manor, you are not only invited to be there, but your attendance is required by the request of your lord.

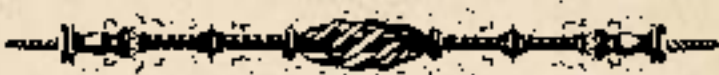
Whether it is to see knights jousting or to partake in the ale and entertainment, your business is but your own... that is until you find yourself in the middle of a murder.

With only one night to find the guilty, you will soon figure out that there is a lot more at stake, for murder in the manor is punishable by death. Whether you are guilty or not, there will be others trying to finger you as the culprit as you try to find the real murderer, and only you can defend your innocence. Whom do you trust? Who will betray you before the night is through? Everyone is a suspect and no one is safe in this mystery of medieval madness.

Be careful in attending.
Your life will depend not only
on your innocence,
but your ability to defend it.



Join us for an evening of mystery & mayhem in the Middle Ages



Rules in the Manor of Fernwood

Whether this is your first murder mystery experience or your fortieth, each murder mystery experience is different and has different rules pertaining. Here are some tips to make sure this evening is an unforgettable experience.

Read Your Character Sheet—This contains your identity and all the information you will need to play your part.

Don't Reveal Everything About Your Character—While there are many things that everyone needs to know about you, there are some things that should remain secret. Use your discretion to not give too much away-- you may find out at the party that you are the killer indeed!

Dress The Part— It's a proven fact that the more into character you are the easier it will be for you to truly enjoy all the aspects of the night. It also adds to the excitement, the photo opps, and your chance to be voted best dressed. Please see www.nightofmystery.com for ideas on costuming.

Review the Announcements—Included in this invite will be manor announcements. Review this page, it includes background information (such as the other characters attending), which may come in useful the night of the party.

Use Your Money Creatively—Upon arrival, you will receive gold coins to spend any way you choose. Bribery and blackmail are two of the most common uses we found (and highly encouraged). The wealthiest player at the end of the night will also receive an award for their ability to turn a profit.

Visit www.aknightofmurder.com for more information on the mystery!

Hear Ye! Hear Ye!

It is by decree of the lord and lady of Fernwood that the people of the manor are invited and ordered to attend the noble marriage of their son, **Baron Bartholomew**, to **Lady Diana of Dunnsberry**. The wedding is to take place on **December Second**, the one year anniversary of their meeting. A tournament of jousting pleasure is to follow to commemorate this momentous occasion in which the victorious knight will be awarded many riches plus the lady of his choice as escort for the celebration that night. Those expected to be in attendance are as follows:

Queen Genevieve-Queen. As ruler of this prosperous kingdom, Genevieve is well liked by everyone. It's hard to have many enemies when the punishment of betrayal is death!

Lord Taylor-Lord of the Manor. In celebration of his only son's marriage to the noblewoman of his choosing, Lord Taylor is determined to host a tournament of epic proportions.

Lady Gwendolyn-Lady of the Manor. Gwendolyn is delighted for the approaching tournament. To Gwendolyn, the celebration symbolizes prosperity and happiness and a chance to marry off her only son to another noble.

Baron Bartholomew-Son to the lord and lady. The tournament is planned in honor of his marriage to another noble on the one year anniversary of his and Diana's meeting. Baron's only regret is that he must marry for wealth instead of love.

Lady Diana of Dunnsberry-Noblewoman. Diana arrived in Fernwood on a quest for a husband. While her heart is now satisfied, another's may now be broken.

Maid Marilyn-Lady-In-Waiting. As Lady Gwendolyn's right-hand woman, Marilyn is like a daughter to the lady. Like a true mother, Gwendolyn will do anything to ensure Marilyn's happiness.

Sir Cameron-Knight. Sir Cameron is looking forward to entertaining and fighting for his honor in the manor tournament. If Cameron wins, rumor is that he will be asking for the favor of Maid Marilyn.

Sir Rufus-Knight. Sir Rufus is looking to boost his unfavorable reputation in the manor lands with a victory over Sir Cameron in the tournament. A triumph will not only win him the favor of a maid, but the popularity which that desires.

Joking Jerry-Court Jester. Jerry is commissioned to make everyone laugh. But at what cost does a laugh turn deadly?

Willie the Watchman-Manor Watchperson. As the guardian for the lord and his manor lands, Willie will be the force that keeps anyone from getting out of hand at the tournament.

Charlamagne-Chambermaid. Occupying the lowest tier of servant-hood in the castle, Charlamagne has unlimited access to all areas of the castle—a privilege others do not possess. While Charlamagne's knowledge of the intimate sections of the castle may be to her advantage, they may also be her ticket to trouble.

Maid Monica-Maid. Since Monica has always caught the Baron's eye (and heart), she assumed a marriage was impending. While Monica's marriage has been arranged, it is not to the person she desires.

Other announcements by the lord: An arranged marriage between **Sir Rufus** to **Maid Monica** to take place next month. Anyone not attending the wedding and celebration will be considered a traitor and will be banished from the manor.

Laws of the Land

As set forth by Queen Genevieve on how his kingdom is to be ruled

I. Betrayal of the queen is punishable by death!!!

II. The lord's word is law in his manor

- a. The only person who can overrule a lord is the queen.
- b. A manor consists of a castle, church and the surrounding lands granted to the lord by the queen.

III. Everyone that makes earnings must tithe a percentage of their earnings to the queen

- a. Percentages are set by the queen.
- b. Tithes (taxes) are collected by Sir Rufus in compliance with the wishes of the queen.

IV. The manor is to be run with a system as follows:

- a. Lords & Ladies—granted land from the queen and may run the manor as they see fit. They award land to the vassals and knights in exchange for protection from invaders. Among their duties are arranging marriages within their manor and administering justice.
- b. Vassals & Knights—are awarded land from the nobles of the manor. They are free to farm the land or pay peasants to do so. They may also have serfs that live on and farm their land.
- c. Peasants—often live in huts outside the castle walls and work on land owned by vassals or knights for a percentage of the profits. They still have their freedom, but own no land.
- d. Serfs—they are slaves to the lord for life. They farm the land for food and shelter, they are not allowed to have earthly possessions and in order to gain any freedom, they must escape and live one year plus one day in another manor. They are never required to fight, but are guaranteed protection from invaders. They need permission to marry.

V. Tournaments are to be a time of great celebration

- a. To be held to honor such events as coronation, a noble marriage or to boost the economy of a manor.
- b. The victorious knight may request the favor of any lady at the celebration. She will then be his escort for the evening.

Baron Bartholomew

As the son of Lord Taylor and Lady Gwendolyn (the lord and lady) who rule the manor of Fernwood for the queen, you have grown up wealthy and are accustomed to getting what you want.

Being of noble descent, you have the pick of the women and you have always fancied Maid Monica (a peasant's daughter). At one point you were certain you were going to marry Maid Monica, for your father (Lord Taylor) had arranged a marriage between the two of you at your request. However, when Lady Diana of Dunnsberry (a noblewoman) came to the manor in search of a husband, your father changed his mind citing that a union with Lady Diana was a better match for you both politically and socially. Since your father IS the lord of the manor, you cannot argue with him - his ruling is law in these parts. (The only person who could overrule him is the queen.)

The tournament being thrown in the castle of Fernwood is in honor of your wedding to Lady Diana. You are to be married on the one year anniversary of when you and Lady Diana met. While you find Lady Diana to be a fine woman, your heart is still with Maid Monica, your childhood sweetheart. Regardless of how your heart feels, you know that it is your position to honor your father's rule or you may be banished. The acceptance of your father's decision has angered Maid Monica and you worry that Monica will do something horrible to ruin the wedding or the tournament.

While you may not be with the woman you love, you hope that the same fate does not await Sir Cameron, a knight and your friend. Sir Cameron will be competing for the hand of Maid Marilyn (Lady Gwendolyn's lady-in-waiting and Sir Cameron's true love) at the tournament. For Sir Cameron's sake, you hope that he wins the tournament and that someone ends up with the woman they love.

In addition to your wedding, you believe your parents are hosting this tournament and celebration to attract the attention of Queen Genevieve (the queen). You have heard rumors circulating that the queen may award rule of the lands to someone else if they find that your parents are unfit rulers. Since the queen will be traveling to the manor, it will give your parents ample opportunity to show off their prosperity and affirm their leadership.

As the celebration approaches, you are excited for your wedding and the tournament. Not only are you looking forward to becoming a married man, but you are anticipating much praise for your parents from the queen during her visit.

Acting and Dressing Your Part: A noble by birth, you act regal and sophisticated as you have been bred to do so. Since your family comes from much wealth and it is your wedding day, you will dress in your medieval best. *For more information, including on ideas on how to dress, who will be at the party, some olde English words to use, etc., please see the party tips page at www.nightofmystery.com or www.aknightofmurder.com*